

Saudi Instrument Rating (IR)

A rating added on top of a PPL or CPL



Indicative study aid — not an official GACA document. Every age, hour, validity period and requirement must be verified against the current GACAR and confirmed with GACA before you rely on it. These points are condensed from the Fly GACA guide named below.

BEFORE YOU START

- Hold a PPL or CPL.
- Meet the English and medical requirements of your base licence.

INSTRUMENT TIME

- 40 h of instrument time minimum.
- Up to 20 h of that may be in an approved simulator.
- Includes instrument cross-country flying.

APPROACHES YOU WILL TRAIN

- Precision and non-precision approach types.
- ILS, RNP / GNSS, VOR and NDB-class procedures.

THEORY & SKILLS TEST

- Written exams in instrument-specific subjects.
- A skills test flown in real or simulated instrument meteorological conditions.

CURRENCY

- Stay current: 6 IFR approaches plus a holding pattern every 6 months.
- Know the Saudi-specific procedures and minima published in the AIP-KSA.

WHAT THE IR REMOVES

- Lifts the day-VFR ceiling — fly legally under IFR in actual IMC.

Condensed from the full Fly GACA guide — <https://flygaca-firebase.web.app/guides/saudi-instrument-rating.html>. Fly GACA is an independent educational reference and is not affiliated with, endorsed by, or connected to the General Authority of Civil Aviation (GACA). The authoritative source for any regulation is always GACA — gaca.gov.sa.